ACTIVE RECONNAISSANCE

TryHackMe Learning & Practical Report

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Program	IqraSec Academy, WAPT Internship (Cohort 02), Phase 1
Task	2. Recon & Enumeration
Platform	TryHackMe
Room	Active Reconnaissance (https://tryhackme.com/room/activerecon)
Focus	active recon, browser, ping, traceroute, telnet, netcat
Completion	100% (all 7 tasks)
Date	October 2026

1. Objective

Understand active reconnaissance: collecting information by interacting directly with the target, using simple tools like a web browser, ping, traceroute, telnet and netcat.

2. Concept / Understanding

- **Active recon:** direct interaction with the target (sending packets, connecting to its services). It gives more information than passive recon, but the target can see and log it, so it can be detected by firewalls and IDS.
- **Web browser:** the browser itself is a recon tool. View-source and Developer Tools show the page code and the requests it makes. Extensions like Wappalyzer (identify technologies) and FoxyProxy (switch proxies) help in testing.
- **ping:** sends ICMP echo requests to check if a host is alive and how fast it answers. A host can still be up even if it does not reply, because firewalls may block ICMP.
- **traceroute:** shows the path (the routers, called hops) between my machine and the target. It uses the TTL value, which goes down by one at each hop.
- **telnet:** connects to a TCP port of a service so I can talk to it manually, for example port 80 to send an HTTP request. It sends data in clear text, so it is not safe for remote login, but it is useful for testing a service.
- **netcat (nc):** a flexible tool to connect to a port or to listen on a port. Useful options: -l listen, -v verbose, -n no DNS lookup, -p port.
- **Banner grabbing:** connecting to a service and reading the banner it returns. It can show the service name and version.

Tools of the room:

Tool	Use
Browser / Dev Tools	inspect the page, requests and technologies
ping	check if a host is alive (ICMP)
traceroute	see the route (hops) to the target
telnet	connect to a TCP port and talk to the service
nc (netcat)	connect to or listen on a port, banner grabbing

3. Practical Work

I finished all 7 tasks of the room (Introduction, Web Browser, Ping, Traceroute, Telnet, Netcat, Putting It All Together) and answered the room's questions about using these tools to gather

information from a target.

4. Tools Used

- TryHackMe AttackBox
- Web browser (Developer Tools)
- ping
- traceroute
- telnet
- netcat (nc)

5. Evidence

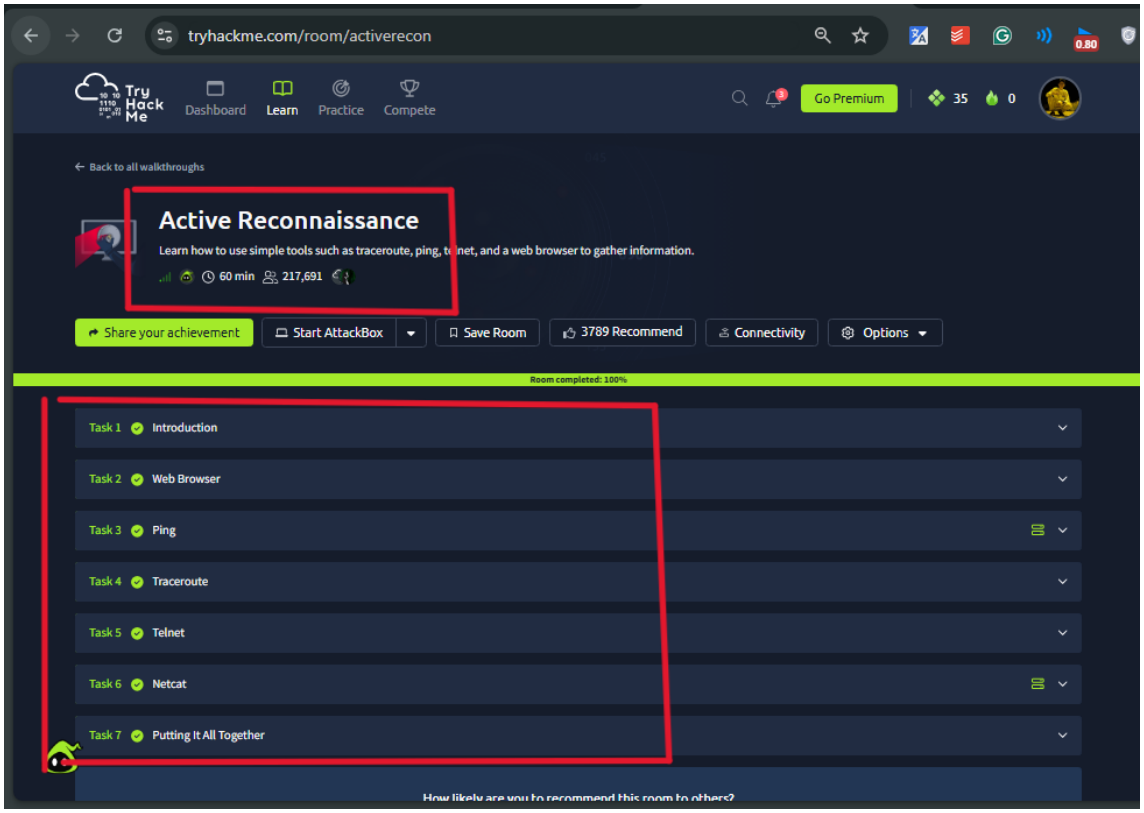


Figure 1: Active Reconnaissance room page, 100% completed, all 7 tasks done.

6. Result

Completed the room 100%. I learned how to use the browser, ping, traceroute, telnet and netcat to collect information from a target, and how this activity can be detected.

7. Key Learnings

- Active recon touches the target directly, so it can be logged and detected, unlike passive recon.
- ping checks if a host is alive, and traceroute shows the path to it.
- telnet and netcat can connect to any TCP port, which is useful to read banners and test services.
- The browser and its Developer Tools already give a lot of information about a web application.